

## » WOMEN'S TEST INDIA-AUSTRALIA



# 'AUS-SOME' WIN, BUT ROCKY ROAD AHEAD

India's victory was its second in Tests this month, having thrashed England by 347 runs in Mumbai. But its **future** in red-ball cricket is still in a limbo.

**Shayan Acharya**

shayan.acharya@thehindu.co.in

**M**ithali Raj had shared a noteworthy insight before India Women's solitary Tests against England and Australia. The former captain emphasised the significance of increasing the number of multi-day red-ball games at the domestic level to provide the players with ample experience before participating in Test matches.

"If you are having a Test match, it should never be a one-off Test

because then it gets very difficult for the current lot to learn about the format, how the format is played, and change the strategy or the skill according to that. It gets difficult for them to add a bit of dimension or work on the variation because it takes time," she told *Sportstar*.

But for India, which

was playing Australia in a Test at home for the first time in close to 40 years, a lack of Test experience did not manifest in its performance. Instead, it dominated all departments, securing an eight-wicket win, the team's first against Australia in this format.

**Securing consecutive Test victories within a week posed a significant challenge.** But on a spin-friendly surface, India relied on the experienced duo of Sneha Rana and Rajeshwari Gayakwad to dismantle the touring side. This triumph was iconic for several reasons — it reaffirmed the women's team's

